Candidate and Campaign Manager Packet

Build your campaign on what voters really care about

Part 1: Find out what voters want

You are running to represent students who are not in your class. The only way to know what they want is to ask them. A campaign built on a guess loses to a campaign built on facts.

How the voter survey works

- Your teacher sets up a short anonymous survey for the voting group: 6 questions about how important an issue is, 2 pick-your-top-three questions, and 1 open question.
- Voters answer on their phones or Chromebooks, on a hallway iPad, or on paper. No names or student IDs are collected, only grade.
- Results are released to every candidate at the same moment, when your teacher closes the survey. Nobody gets a head start.
- A grade breakdown only appears when at least 5 students in that grade answered, so no one can be singled out.
- Your teacher hides any open answer that names a person.

Issues students are asked about

- Middle school: lunch quality and time, hall passes and bathrooms, phone rules, homework and test scheduling, dress code, recess, bullying and kindness, clubs and dances, safety, Chromebooks, sports and PE, bus and pickup.
- High school: phone rules, start time, lunch, dress code, homework and testing stress, mental health support, college and career prep, clubs and homecoming, safety, AI and tech policy, sports and arts funding, cyberbullying and respect.

Get out of your own class

- Your classmates already know you. The voters are in a different class or grade, so go meet them.
- Talk to at least 10 voters face to face. Ask open questions: What is one thing you would change? Why?
- Listen more than you talk. Write down what they say, not what you hoped they would say.
- Never ask who someone is voting for. Never pressure anyone.

Turn the data into a platform

1. Read the results. Which issues scored highest? Which came up in conversations too?
2. Pick two or three issues you can really affect from this office. Be honest about what the office can and cannot do.
3. Write each platform point as a promise that someone could check later.

4 Add the survey finding your platform is built on. Your campaign page then shows a Backed by survey badge.

5 Test your message on three voters from another class. If they do not understand it, rewrite it.

Part 2: Field notes sheet

Copy this sheet and fill one in for each conversation. Do not write the voter's name.

For each conversation

Copy this sheet for each conversation
• Date and place:
• Grade of the voter (not the name):
• What they said matters most to them:
• A quote in their own words:
• One thing I did not expect:
• How this changes my platform:

Part 3: Fundraising guide

Supporters can give toward the school's fundraiser and name the candidate they back. Those gifts become super votes in a separate Spirit Award tally. They never count as votes. Only students at the booth decide who wins.

The ethics rules

- Gifts never change the vote. The winner is decided by one student, one vote.
- Adults give. Students never pay with their own money.
- No pressure, no guilt, and no hints that a gift will earn a favor. Never promise anything in return.
- Be clear about the cause. Tell every donor where the money goes before they give.
- Students never handle cash. All gifts go through the online page, and the candidate never receives the money.
- Be honest when you ask. Say what the school is raising money for and how it will be used.
- Take no for an answer, and thank everyone who gives or listens.
- Tell your teacher right away if anything about a gift seems wrong.

Where donations come from

- Family and friends: parents, grandparents, neighbors and family friends.
- Local businesses: ask a business owner if they would support the school's cause. Your teacher helps with any formal sponsorship.

- Alumni and community groups: former students, faith groups, clubs and civic organizations.
- Employer matching: many companies match gifts their employees make to schools. Ask a parent to check with their employer.
- Always get your teacher's approval before you ask anyone outside your family.

How a gift is received

1. A supporter opens the school's support page from a link or QR code and picks the candidate they want to back.
2. They choose a gift amount and pay by card or Cash App Pay. The page says plainly that the gift does not count as a vote.
3. The school keeps 96% of every gift. BoutCasts keeps 4%. The payment processor also charges its own fee.
4. Your teacher sees every gift on the fundraiser page, and the total counts toward the school's goal.
5. The supporter gets a receipt from the payment processor.

How the money can be used

- Your teacher names the cause before fundraising starts, such as a school library, a field trip fund or a charity.
- The money goes to the school or the cause. It never goes to a candidate.
- At the end, the school shares a short report of how much was raised and how it was spent.

Build a fundraising strategy

1. Set a goal and a deadline. Small and specific works better than big and vague.
2. Make a donor map: list the adults you can honestly ask, and which of them your teacher has approved.
3. Write a 30-second pitch: the cause, why it matters, and how a gift helps.
4. Match your ask to your donor. A neighbor, a business owner and a grandparent need different words.
5. Track what you do: who you asked, who said yes, and what worked. Do not track or share anyone's private information.
6. Send a thank-you note to everyone who gave. Thank-yous build trust for the next election.